



Questionnaire: Imagine Education - Eden Academy

MN-05049

Deadline to respond: 1 October 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing the proposed acquisition by Imagine Education Holdings Pty Ltd (**Imagine Education**), part of the Imagine Education Group, of entities that operate or manage a portfolio of childcare centres, from the shareholders of the Eden Academy Group (**Eden Academy**) (the **Acquisition**).

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

Through the Acquisition, Imagine Education would acquire 58 operating Eden Academy childcare centres. In addition, Imagine Education proposes to acquire 100% of the shares in Eden Academy Management Pty Ltd, which would hold rights to manage a further 10 Eden Academy childcare centres. Imagine Education would also manage (but not acquire) two further Eden Academy childcare centres that would continue to be owned by Eden Academy post-Acquisition.

A further 11 sites of childcare centres are proposed to be developed by the current owners of the Eden Academy Group, with Imagine Education being granted options to acquire the entities associated with those centres and sites.

There is an overlap between the Eden Academy operated or managed childcare centres proposed to be acquired and Imagine Education centres in the following areas:

- **Queensland:** Rural View, Beaconsfield, Kerrisdale, Mount Pleasant, Harris Crossing, Loganlea, Edens Landing, Park Ridge, Little Bardon, Auchenflower, Bardon, Woodridge, Broadbeach Waters, Woolloowin, Pacific Pines, Isle of Capri, Redbank Plains, Hamilton
- **New South Wales:** Dubbo
- **South Australia:** Angle Vale, Salisbury Heights, Parafield Gardens, Newton
- **Victoria:** Harkness, Thornhill Park, Fraser Rise, Clyde, Junction Village, Botanic Ridge, Cranbourne, Mambourin, Werribee, Thomastown, Doreen, Glenroy, Pascoe Vale, Oak Park.

The above list does not include those sites over which an option may be exercised in future.

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information

in response to the questions below by **1 October 2026** via email to mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Imagine Education – Eden Academy*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Imagine Education – Eden Academy*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [general confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

1. Outline any concerns regarding the impact of the Acquisition on competition in the supply of childcare services.

2. Do Imagine Education and Eden Academy operated childcare centres compete closely in the supply of childcare services? As part of your response, describe whether there are certain areas where the removal of Eden Academy as an alternative to an Imagine Education site would impact competition.

3. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships with Imagine Education and/or Eden Academy.

4. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

Questions for operators of childcare centres

5. Identify the childcare centres you operate that compete for enrolments with an Imagine Education and/or Eden Academy childcare centre, including its location.

6. Identify the characteristics of your childcare centres identified in Question Error: Reference source not found above that you consider are most important in attracting new customers (for example location, educator:child ratios, inclusions, facilities etc.).

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [confidentiality quick guide](#).